Illinois Brady/Giglio officer database: Methodology

Overview

The database lists law enforcement officers and other law enforcement experts who appear on Brady/Giglio lists or in related records kept by Illinois prosecuting offices. It contains 1,094 records. Prosecutors in 41 counties listed at least one officer.

Brady and Giglio refer to U.S. Supreme Court rulings (Brady v. Maryland, 1963, and Giglio v. United States, 1972) that require prosecutors to give defendants evidence that could help their case, including information that could undermine an officer's credibility. Illinois Supreme Court Rule 412 sets out related disclosure requirements.

How we obtained the data

The database stems from records that fit the scope of a Freedom of Information Act request. The request went to all of Illinois' 102 county prosecutors, the Illinois Attorney General's Office and the Illinois State's Attorneys Appellate Prosecutor.

The records that came back took several forms:

- Lists
- Memos
- Emails
- Court transcripts
- Sustained disciplinary findings

Sample request

The request was last sent in April 2026. Below is the text of that request.

> Pursuant to IL FOIA, I hereby request records sufficient to show any and all law enforcement officers or other law enforcement experts, past or present, who have been identified as subject to disclosure requirements by your office under the U.S. Supreme Court Cases Brady v. Maryland (1963) and Giglio v. United States (1972), and/or Illinois Supreme Court Rule 412.
>
> These records may include lists, memos, court filings, emails or any other records held by the prosecutor's office that detail the fact that there exists some impeachment material about that specific officer in the SAO's possession that is subject to potential disclosure.
>
> These are public records under the Illinois Freedom of Information Act. The legislature has declared that "access [to government records] is necessary to enable the people to fulfill their duties of discussing public

> issues fully and freely, making informed political judgments and monitoring government to ensure that it is being conducted in the public interests." 5 ILCS 140/1.
>
> An agency may not deny access to records on grounds that they contain confidential or non-disclosable information; the agency may delete the confidential or non-disclosable information and must disclose the remainder of the record. See 5 ILCS 140/7.
>
> In the event the SAO denies or redacts any of the requested information, please provide the legal reasoning behind every denial and/or redaction, as well as "the reasons for the denial, including a detailed factual basis for the application of any exemption claimed," pursuant to 5 ILCS 140/9(a). Please provide a response within five business days, as required by 5 ILCS 140/3(d).

How we compiled the data

1. Reporters reviewed the records that came back from prosecuting offices.
2. Reporters culled those records into a list of officer or law enforcement expert names, departments and counties, along with the category of misconduct and the type of source, such as whether the information came from a list or a memo.
3. Reporters matched those names and departments to unique Illinois Law Enforcement Training and Standards Board (ILETSB) ID numbers using ILETSB data.
4. Reporters used the same ILETSB data to determine whether each person was still active and, if so, which agency employed them and in which county. The ILETSB data was current as of August 2026.

Judgement calls

Including officers from all Cook County lists

Cook County records come from more than one list. Former Cook County State's Attorney Kim Foxx maintained two Brady lists: a "do not call" list and a disclosure list. Current State's Attorney Eileen O'Neill Burke initially kept her own list before moving to an internal drive.

We chose to include officers from all of those lists on the assumption that there was underlying Brady material on each.

The "Type of Source" column shows which list or lists named each officer, so readers can see where a name came from.

Other decisions

- Officers who appear in records from more than one county have all of those counties listed.
- People who are not sworn officers, such as dispatchers, corrections staff and crime lab employees, are included because Brady/Giglio covers law enforcement experts and other personnel.

Data dictionary

Variable	What it means	Based on
Officer Name	The officer's or law enforcement expert's name, in first-last order.	Prosecutor records
ILETSB ID	The unique number the Illinois Law Enforcement Training and Standards Board assigns to a certified officer. Blank when no match was found.	ILETSB data, matched by name and department
Role	The job title for people who are not sworn officers, such as "911 Dispatcher" or "Forensic Toxicologist."	Prosecutor records. In the original spreadsheet, these titles appeared in the ILETSB ID column.
County who placed on Brady List	The county prosecutor's office (or offices) whose records named the officer.	Prosecutor records
Department of Misconduct	The department where the officer worked when the misconduct or concern was recorded.	Prosecutor records
Date of Finding	Some entries show only a year because the source data recorded only a year.	Prosecutor records
Category of Misconduct	The type of concern the records cited. See categories below.	Prosecutor records
Type of Source	The kind of record that named the officer. See source labels below.	Prosecutor records
Current Status	Whether the person is currently employed in Illinois law enforcement. See statuses below.	ILETSB data as of August 2026
Current Agency	The agency that currently employs the person, if any.	ILETSB data as of August 2026
Current County/Counties	The county or counties where the current agency is based. "Multiple" means the agency covers more than one county.	ILETSB data as of August 2026

Categories of misconduct

Category	What it means	Records
No Reason Listed	The prosecutor did not specify why the officer was placed on their Brady list.	441
Credibility/Bias Issue	The officer was cited for dishonesty, not being credible or being biased.	354
Misconduct	A range of misconduct that did not center on bias or credibility but still resulted in a sustained disciplinary finding against the officer.	96

Category	What it means	Records
Criminal Charge/Arrest	The officer was charged with or arrested for a crime.	87
Criminal Conviction	The officer was convicted of a crime.	87
Investigation	An investigation into alleged wrongdoing by the officer was pending.	14
Complaint	A complaint alleging wrongdoing by the officer.	10
Lawsuit	A civil lawsuit alleging wrongdoing by the officer.	5

Source labels

Cook County sources use these labels:

- **Foxx (DNC):** Former State's Attorney Kim Foxx's "do not call" list
- **Foxx (Disclosure):** Former State's Attorney Kim Foxx's disclosure list
- **Burke (Disclosure):** Current State's Attorney Eileen O'Neill Burke's disclosure list from February 2025
- **Burke (Stripped):** Burke's list of stripped officers from the Chicago Police Department as of February 2025
- **Brady/Giglio File -- Burke:** Names from an internal file the State's Attorney's Office currently maintains

Records with more than one label appeared on more than one list. Other labels, such as Letter, Email, Memo, Court Filing and Court transcript, describe the type of document the information came from.

Current status

- **Active:** An active duty officer.
- **Inactive:** The person is not currently working in law enforcement.
- **Decertified:** The person cannot work in law enforcement in Illinois.
- **No Illinois law enforcement employment:** The person is not employed in Illinois law enforcement.
- **Not listed:** The status was not available.

Limitations

- **The database is not a complete list of officers who should be on Brady lists.** As our reporting identifies, many officers might be missing. The data cannot tell readers how many officers in their county have credibility problems or other material that prosecutors should disclose.
- **The database reflects what prosecutors provided.** Offices differ in how they define, track and share this information, and some records came without a date or a reason.
- **Current status reflects ILETSB data as of August 2026.**

Credits

Reporting by Max Blaisdell and Sam Stecklow.